



Photo courtesy: Kishal Das (kishal@redhat.com)

Jared Smith with Fedora community in India

appears to have a very strong FOSS ecosystem. The focus on high-tech jobs and the willingness to work hard, combined with the high costs of proprietary software, make FOSS a perfect fit. I'm sure we'll continue to see very strong adoption of FOSS in India.

Q Fedora releases are known for missing deadlines. Any reasons why this trend continues?

While Fedora attempts to stick to its schedule, the important thing to note is that Fedora releases are criteria-based releases not time-based releases. We purposely put a checkpoint into our schedule at the time of Alpha, Beta, and Final release so that our quality assurance can test to ensure the releases meet all of the release criteria. If a particular release doesn't meet all of the criteria, we would rather delay the schedule by a week and try again rather than release a product that doesn't meet our quality standards.

Q In the last few years, Linux has consolidated its stake in the server market. However, there's some way to go when it comes to the desktop adoption of Linux distributions. What are the key reasons behind this and do you see this trend reversing anytime soon?

Various people have been prognosticating the "Year of the Linux Desktop" for quite a number of years now, and yet we still haven't seen it. I think there are a number of reasons for this, including the entrenched position of the dominant players in traditional desktop operating systems and applications. As more and more applications move from a desktop-centric model to a

"The Fedora Project creates a world where free culture is welcoming and widespread, collaboration is common-place, and people control their content and devices."

Web-based model, I think we'll continue to see small but consistent gains in desktop adoption of Linux.

Q Are you planning to make Fedora 16 popular on the desktop front?

We always try to make Fedora appealing to tech-savvy desktop users. Over the past couple of years, we've seen great strides being made in most of the desktop environments supported in Fedora. We've also worked to integrate the various pieces of the desktop environment to help provide for a more cohesive experience between applications.

Involvement with other projects

Q Apart from Fedora, which are the other key global open source projects to which you have contributed?

Earlier in my career, I made quite a number of contributions (both in terms of documentation, code and evangelism) to Asterisk, the most popular open source telecommunications platform. I've also made patches for a number of other programs and contributed quite a number of bug reports to myriad open source projects.